# TapCast Dawn Alert: Frequently Asked Questions

Khlong Mek Weather Services Co., Ltd., Surat Thani · Subscriber Care · Ref. KMW-FAQ-TC-2026-03 · Version 3.0 · Updated 18 September 2026

This FAQ is for rubber smallholders, tapping teams and cooperatives using TapCast Dawn Alert. It replaces Version 2.2 of February 2026.

## 1. About the service

### What is TapCast Dawn Alert?

TapCast Dawn Alert is a pre-dawn weather message that tells you whether it is worth tapping your rubber plot that morning. Rain on freshly cut panels washes latex out of the cup and can spread panel disease, so our forecasters look at the five hours that matter most to tappers, from 03:00 to 08:00, for the 5 km grid cell that contains your plot. The service covers plots in Surat Thani, Nakhon Si Thammarat, Chumphon and Phang Nga.

### When will I receive the message?

The main alert is sent at 02:30 every morning, all year round, including public holidays. Until 30 June 2026 the main alert was sent at 03:15; it was moved earlier because many teams start cutting before 03:00. Plots that receive an AMBER code also get a second message, the 04:30 update, which confirms or changes the code.

### What do the colour codes mean?

- **GREEN – TAP:** the chance of 2 mm or more of rain on your grid cell between 03:00 and 08:00 is below 30 %.
- **AMBER – WAIT:** the chance is between 30 % and 60 %. Prepare as usual but wait for the 04:30 update before cutting.
- **RED – DO NOT TAP:** the chance is above 60 %, or lightning is expected within 10 km of your plot during the window.
- **STORM MODE:** sent instead of a colour code on days when a tropical storm or heavy-rain warning covers your province. No tapping advice is given on these days.

## 2. Plans and prices

### Which plans are available?

- **Basic:** 59 baht per month. SMS alert for one plot, main alert and 04:30 update.
- **Plus:** 99 baht per month. Up to three plots, alerts by SMS and LINE, and a three-day tapping outlook every Sunday evening.
- **Cooperative:** 35 baht per member per month, with a minimum of 20 members. Each member gets the Plus features for one plot, and the cooperative receives a single monthly invoice.

Paying for a full year in advance gives you twelve months for the price of ten on the Basic and Plus plans. The annual discount does not apply to the Cooperative plan, which is billed monthly only.

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### Is there a free trial?

Yes. New subscribers on the Basic or Plus plan get 14 days free. The trial was 30 days for anyone who joined before 31 May 2026. Only one free trial is given per mobile number.

## 3. Registering and changing a plot

### How do I register my plot?

1. Add the LINE official account @tapcastkm, or call the Subscriber Care line on 077 410 286.
2. Send the location pin of your plot, taken while standing inside the plot, not at your house.
3. Tell us the time your team usually starts cutting, between 01:00 and 04:00. This lets us warn you if rain is expected before 03:00.
4. Choose your plan and pay, or start your free trial.
5. Reply "OK" to the confirmation SMS. Alerts begin from the next morning if your reply is received before 20:00.

### Can I move my plot to a different location?

Yes. Send the new location pin through LINE or the Subscriber Care line. Changes received before 20:00 take effect the next morning. Basic subscribers may change the plot location twice per calendar month at no charge; each further change costs 20 baht. Plus and Cooperative subscribers can change locations without a fee.

## 4. Forecast quality and responsibility

### Who prepares the forecasts?

Forecasts are produced at our forecast centre on Talat Mai Road, Surat Thani, by a duty team of two forecasters on every night shift. The duty team combines regional model output with radar data and readings from 146 partner rain gauges, most of them installed at cooperative collection points. The Chief Duty Forecaster, Ms Supattra Nimmanee, reviews and signs off every 04:30 update before it is sent. Changes to the colour-code thresholds or to the forecast models can only be approved by the Head of Forecast Operations, Mr Kittisak Sornprasit.

### How accurate is TapCast?

During the 2025–2026 tapping season, 88 % of GREEN days stayed dry enough to tap, measured as less than 2 mm of rain at the nearest partner gauge between 03:00 and 08:00. For RED days, rain of 2 mm or more actually fell on 81 % of occasions. Accuracy is usually lower in November and December, during the northeast monsoon.

## 5. The Rain Guarantee

### What happens if I get GREEN and it rains?

If your plot received a GREEN code and the nearest partner gauge recorded 5 mm or more of rain between 03:00 and 08:00 that morning, you can claim a Rain Guarantee credit of 10 baht against your

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next bill. You can receive at most 3 credits per calendar month. Credits are not paid in cash and expire if you cancel the service.

> **Note.** No Rain Guarantee credit is given on STORM MODE days, for plots registered with a location pin taken outside the plot, or for the first 3 days after a plot location change.

### How do I claim a credit?

1. Within 7 days of the morning concerned, open the LINE official account and type "RAIN".
2. Select the date and the plot from the menu.
3. Wait for the result, which is sent within 5 working days after the gauge record has been checked.

### Who decides on my claim, and can I appeal?

Claims are checked by the Subscriber Care team against the gauge records. If you disagree with the result, reply "APPEAL" within 14 days of the decision. Appeals are decided by the Subscriber Care Manager, Ms Ratchanee Phothisan, and her decision is final. The forecast team does not handle claims or appeals.

## 6. Pausing and cancelling

### Can I pause the service during the leaf-fall season?

Yes. Most plots stop tapping during wintering, when the trees shed their leaves, usually between February and April. You can pause your subscription once per calendar year for up to 90 days without charge. To pause, send "PAUSE" and your planned restart date through LINE or call Subscriber Care by the 25th of the month before the pause starts. Alerts restart automatically on the date you gave. Cooperative members must ask their cooperative office, which arranges pauses for the whole group.

### How do I cancel?

Send "STOP" by SMS to 4 2 8 6 1 or through LINE. Monthly plans end at the end of the current billing month. Annual payments are refunded for the full unused months, minus a 50 baht handling fee, if you cancel within the first six months; after six months annual payments are not refunded.

## 7. Messages, outages and your data

### What if the SMS does not arrive?

If the main alert has not arrived by 02:50, call the recorded TapCast line on 077 410 299, enter your mobile number and you will hear the code for your plot.

### Who can see my plot location?

Your location pin is used only to choose your grid cell and nearest gauge. On the Cooperative plan, the cooperative manager can see the grid cell of each member, but not the exact pin.

For any other question, the Subscriber Care line, 077 410 286, is open from 07:00 to 19:00, Monday to Saturday.

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